

Solid Waste Committee
Report to 2022 AGM. April 28, 2022

Special thanks goes to Paul Duncan for his very extensive research into the various aspects of the solid waste facility and operations. Thanks also to Louise for faithfully managing the garbage during many chilly days. Thanks to all for their patience as the best path forward unfolds for the recycle facility.

Thetis has put significant effort toward accepting only clean recyclable products. This is possible only under a close double handling policy. This caused us to stop accepting recycling products during covid. We were never able to establish a formal agreement with CVRD who has been hauling the majority of our product since 2016. Over time their complaint was that it took too much time to unload the closely packed 40 yard roll-off. Although, in their favour we shipped many products that were previously hauled by volunteers like glass, paint, aerosols, foam, etc. My hope over the last several months has been to find an efficient alternative to how we package and ship our product. Much volunteer time and effort over several years has brought us to this point. We need to continue to adjust to the continuously evolving recycling world.

I toured Hornby's recycle centre in 2006. They started out in 1978 so have had over 40 years to fine tune. They have 6 employees, operate 3 days a week for 4 hours in winter and 4 days a week in summer. They have 3 times our population so are linked with Recycle BC and the Stewardship programs. Their free store operates for 2 hours during their open days, run by volunteers. They have significant infrastructure. This is a distant dream for Thetis as we don't even own our site. We are tasked to determine what Thetis is reasonably capable of doing that is efficient and sustainable over time.

As a minimum it seems we would pay for prepping and hauling what is normally put into the curbside blue box system, and take the rest into the depot of our choice. It seems unlikely that Recycle BC is going to do anything for us at all. GFL will haul our blue box product, not baled, at an approximate cost of \$5,000 per year. You still have to take your styrofoam, glass jars, bottles, paints, aerosols, plastic bags etc to a depot.

Let's consider the information that Paul has presented and come to a consensus. Our garbage weight for 2012 was 67 MT, 2019 was 19 MT, 2020 was 19.4 MT, 2021 was 20.4 MT. Average recycling is 12.8 MT per year.

I am not in favour of any motion to hire a paid manager. If a new manager is required, then that person should be elected as the new chair of the Solid Waste Committee. The yard needs two employees when it is handling garbage and recycling.

Respectfully submitted,
Ernie Hunter, SWMC chair